

Instructions:

1. This question paper contains 50 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The duration of the examination is 90 minutes.
3. Each question carries 2 marks. There is no negative marks for wrong answers.
4. Use only blue or black ball-point pen to mark your answers on the OMR Answer Sheet.
5. The use of calculators, mobile phones, smart watches, log tables, or any electronic gadgets is strictly prohibited.

English

1. Choose the word that best **completes the sentence**:

The principal's message was firm yet _____, making students reflect rather than rebel.

- (A) aggressive (B) considerate
(C) careless (D) indifferent

2. **Identify the part of the sentence that has an error**:

Scarcely had the bell rung when the students starts rushing out of the classroom.

- (A) Scarcely had
(B) the bell rung
(C) when the students
(D) starts rushing

3. Choose the most **appropriate analogy**:

Seed : Germination :: Idea : _____

- (A) discussion (B) creation
(C) execution (D) imagination

4. Choose the option that best explains the function of the **underlined clause**:

What he said during the debate surprised everyone.

- (A) Adjective clause
(B) Adverb clause
(C) Noun clause
(D) Independent clause

5. Choose the sentence in which the **reflexive pronoun** is correctly used.

- (A) She herself blamed for the error.
(B) She blamed herself for the error.
(C) She blamed for herself the error.
(D) She blamed herself herself.

6. Choose the correct **phrasal verb**:
The plan was well designed, but it failed because the team did not _____ it properly.

- (A) carry on (B) carry off
(C) carry through (D) carry away

7. Choose the correct **tense sequence**:
By the time the judge arrived, the final round _____.

- (A) begins (B) had begun
(C) has begun (D) was beginning

8. Choose the most appropriate **modal verb**:

You _____ have checked the instructions before submitting the form.

- (A) can (B) must
(C) should (D) may

9. Choose the word that best fits the **context**:

His explanation was so _____ that it removed even the slightest confusion.

- (A) ambiguous (B) superficial
(C) explicit (D) hesitant

10. Choose the option that correctly **completes the sentence**:

She spoke _____, yet her message was powerful.

- (A) softly (B) soft
(C) softness (D) softer

11. Choose the correct **determiner–noun** combination:

There is _____ evidence to support his claim.

- (A) many (B) few
(C) little (D) several

12. Choose the sentence that shows **correct inversion**.

- (A) Rarely we witness such honesty.
(B) Rarely do we witness such honesty.
(C) Rarely did we witness such honesty do.
(D) Rarely witness we such honesty.

13. Choose the correct **article** usage:
He was elected _____ head boy of the school.

- (A) a (B) an
(C) the (D) no article

14. Choose the correct **subject–verb agreement**:

A series of workshops _____ organised to improve communication skills.

- (A) were (B) are
(C) is (D) have

15. Identify the **odd** one out based on meaning:

- (A) cautious (B) vigilant
(C) careless (D) alert

16. Choose the most suitable **one-word substitute**:

A person who intentionally pretends to be ignorant

- (A) Cynic
(B) Hypocrite
(C) Ignoramus
(D) Simpleton

17. Choose the **idiom** that means “to accept the consequences bravely”.

- (A) Pass the buck
(B) Face the music
(C) Hit the nail on the head
(D) Throw in the towel

18. Choose the correct **indirect speech**:
The teacher said, “You must complete this assignment today.”

- (A) The teacher said that we must complete that assignment today.
(B) The teacher said that we had to complete the assignment that day.
(C) The teacher said we must complete this assignment.
(D) The teacher told that we had to complete the assignment today.

19. Choose the correct **passive voice**:

Someone has stolen the confidential files.

- (A) The confidential files were stolen.
- (B) The confidential files have been stolen.
- (C) The confidential files are stolen.
- (D) The confidential files had stolen.

20. Choose the correct **preposition**:

His success was the result _____ years of dedication and discipline.

- (A) by (B) of
- (C) for (D) with

21. Choose the correct **conjunction**:

He was nervous, _____ he spoke with remarkable confidence.

- (A) because (B) although
- (C) yet (D) therefore

22. Choose the correctly **spelt word**:

- (A) Exaggeration (B) Exagerration
- (C) Exaggeretion (D) Exagerrattion

23. Choose the **synonym** of "meticulous".

- (A) careless (B) thorough
- (C) hurried (D) casual

24. Choose the **antonym** of "resilient".

- (A) flexible (B) strong
- (C) fragile (D) firm

25. Choose the option with correct **syllable stress**:

- (A) im-POR-tant (B) IM-por-tant
- (C) im-por-TANT (D) IM-POR-tant

26. Choose the correct **jumbled sentence**:

(A) no sooner / had / the announcement / made / been / than / the hall / erupted

(B) no sooner / had / been / the announcement / made / than / erupted / the hall

(C) no sooner / the announcement / had / been made / than / the hall / erupted

(D) no sooner / had / the announcement / been made / than / erupted / hall the

27. Choose the correct **quantifier**:

There is _____ chance of completing the project without teamwork.

- (A) many (B) little
- (C) few (D) several

28. Choose the correct **collocation**:

- (A) draw a conclusion
- (B) make a conclusion
- (C) do a conclusion
- (D) give a conclusion

29. Identify the type of **clause**:

The reason why he resigned remains unknown.

- (A) Noun clause
- (B) Adjective clause
- (C) Adverb clause
- (D) Main clause

30. Choose the sentence that is **grammatically** and **logically** correct.

- (A) She insisted me to attend the meeting.
- (B) She insisted that I attend the meeting.
- (C) She insisted to attend me the meeting.
- (D) She insisted I to attend the meeting.

31. Choose the **antonym** of “transparent”.

- (A) visible (B) obvious
(C) opaque (D) bright

32. Choose the **synonym** of “inevitable”.

- (A) avoidable (B) uncertain
(C) unavoidable (D) optional

33. Choose the correct **word formation**:

Decide → _____

- (A) decision (B) decisive
(C) decisively (D) deciding

34. Choose the sentence with correct **punctuation**:

- (A) Yes, however I disagree.
(B) Yes however, I disagree.
(C) Yes, however, I disagree.
(D) Yes however I, disagree.

35. Choose the most **appropriate response**:

“I regret to inform you that your request cannot be approved.”

- (A) That’s unfair.
(B) I understand. Thank you for informing me.
(C) Why not?
(D) You are wrong.

36. Choose the sentence that best expresses **constructive advice**.

- (A) You always make mistakes.
(B) You should try revising the concept once more.
(C) Don’t ever do this again.
(D) This is useless.

37. Choose the sentence showing **polite disagreement**.

(A) I completely disagree with you.

(B) That’s not true at all.

(C) I see your point, but I think there’s another way to look at it.

(D) You are mistaken.

38. Choose the most appropriate sentence for **seeking permission formally**.

(A) Let me leave early.

(B) I am leaving early.

(C) May I be excused early today, Sir?

(D) I want to leave early.

39. Choose the most suitable **telephonic response**:

Caller: May I speak to the manager, please?

(A) He is busy.

(B) Who is calling?

(C) May I know who’s calling, please?

(D) Call later.

40. Choose the sentence that conveys information **clearly and objectively**.

(A) I feel the event might be cancelled.

(B) The event scheduled for Friday has been postponed to next week.

(C) The event is boring.

(D) Maybe there is no event.

For Questions 41 To 45 Read the passage carefully and Answer the questions that follow.

In a small coastal town, frequent flooding had become a serious concern. While many residents complained about the problem, only a few took action. Aarushi, a young student, began

researching the causes of flooding and discovered that improper waste disposal was blocking drainage systems. She shared her findings with local authorities and organised awareness drives in her neighbourhood. Gradually, people began changing their habits, and the flooding reduced significantly. Aarushi learned that real change begins when responsibility replaces blame.

- 41.** What was the main cause of flooding according to Aarushi?
- (A) Heavy rainfall
(B) Rising sea levels
(C) Blocked drainage due to waste
(D) Poor road construction
- 42.** How did Aarushi respond to the problem?
- (A) She complained to officials
(B) She researched and created awareness
(C) She moved to another town
(D) She ignored the issue
- 43.** What change occurred after Aarushi's efforts?
- (A) Flooding increased
(B) People protested
(C) Habits gradually changed
(D) Authorities ignored the issue
- 44.** What does the passage suggest about responsibility?
- (A) It belongs only to authorities
(B) It is ineffective
(C) It leads to meaningful change
(D) It creates conflict

45. Which quality of Aarushi is most clearly highlighted?

- (A) Curiosity
(B) Leadership and initiative
(C) Fearlessness
(D) Obedience

For Questions 46 To 50 Read the passage carefully and Answer the questions that follow.

During a national debate competition, participants were evaluated not only on their speaking skills but also on their ability to listen and respond thoughtfully. Arvind initially struggled because he focused only on memorising arguments. Over time, he learned to analyse opposing views, adjust his responses, and present balanced opinions. His improvement showed that effective communication depends as much on listening as on speaking.

46. What were participants evaluated on besides speaking skills?

- (A) Writing ability
(B) Listening and responding thoughtfully
(C) Speed of speech
(D) Confidence alone

47. Why did Arvind struggle at first?

- (A) He lacked confidence
(B) He spoke too slowly
(C) He focused only on memorisation
(D) He did not prepare

48. What helped Arvind improve?

- (A) Speaking louder
- (B) Ignoring opponents
- (C) Analysing opposing views
- (D) Memorising more facts

49. What is the central idea of the passage?

- (A) Debate competitions are difficult
- (B) Speaking is more important than listening

(C) Effective communication involves listening

(D) Memorisation ensures success

50. Which word from the passage means “**considered carefully**”?

- (A) memorising
- (B) thoughtful
- (C) balanced
- (D) effective

